Problem 8 | Problems T5_MechanicalProperties.pdf #8 | Yield strength · Hooke's law

Elastic Limits of a Brass Sample: Stress, Load and Length without Plastic Deformation

Original statement · Problems T5_MechanicalProperties.pdf, p. 4

8. For a particular kind of brass, plastic deformation begins at 345 MPa, and its elastic modulus is 103 GPa.

- *a. What is the value of the yield stress?*
- *b. What is the maximum stress that can be applied to a sample of this brass with a cross-section 130 mm² without plastic deformation taking place? And the maximum load?*
- *c. If the initial length of the sample is 76 mm, what is the maximum length that it can reach without plastic deformation?*

Official Solution: a. $\sigma_y = 345$ **MPa; b.** $\sigma_{max} = 345$ **MPa,** $F_{max} = 44850$ **N; c.** $l = 76.25$ **mm**

HYPOTHESES & PARAMETERS

Hypotheses

1. **Yield strength.** "Plastic deformation begins at 345 MPa" means that 345 MPa is the yield strength of the brass: below it the deformation is only elastic, above it part of it is permanent [Session 11 Slide 28].
2. **Linear elastic below the yield strength**, $\sigma = E\varepsilon$ [Session 11 Slide 13], with the given modulus.
3. **Uniaxial, uniform stress**: $\sigma = F/A_0$ and $\varepsilon = \Delta l/l_0$ [Session 11 Slide 9]. The maximum values without plastic deformation are those that correspond to the stress σ_y.

Data

Quantity	Symbol	Value	In SI
Stress at which plastic deformation begins	σ_y	345 MPa	345×10^6 Pa
Young's modulus	E	103 GPa	103 000 N/mm²
Cross-section (item b)	A_0	130 mm²	130×10^{-6} m²
Initial length (item c)	l_0	76 mm	76×10^{-3} m

Unknowns: σ_y (a), the maximum stress and load (b), the maximum length (c).

MODEL & STRATEGY

One direction (the axis of the sample), no change of basis.

Strategy. The three items are the same limit seen from three sides. The largest stress that does not cause plastic deformation is the yield strength (a, b). The largest load is that stress times the area, $F = \sigma_y A_0$ (b). The largest length is the initial length plus the elongation at the yield strength, and that elongation comes from Hooke's law, $\varepsilon_y = \sigma_y / E$ and $\Delta l = \varepsilon_y \, l_0$ (c).

STEP-BY-STEP CALCULATION

a) Yield stress

By the hypothesis, plastic deformation begins when $\sigma = 345$ MPa, so

$$\sigma_y = \mathbf{345\ MPa}$$

b) Maximum stress and maximum load

Without plastic deformation the stress cannot be larger than the yield strength, so

$$\sigma_{max} = \sigma_y = \mathbf{345\ MPa}$$

The load that produces that stress in a section of 130 mm² follows from $\sigma = F / A_0$:

$$F_{max} = \sigma_{max}\, A_0 = 345\ \frac{\mathrm{N}}{\mathrm{mm}^2} \times 130\ \mathrm{mm}^2 = 44\,850\ \mathrm{N} = \mathbf{44.85\ kN}$$

c) Maximum length without plastic deformation

The strain at the yield strength comes from Hooke's law:

$$\varepsilon_y = \frac{\sigma_y}{E} = \frac{345\ \mathrm{N/mm^2}}{103000\ \mathrm{N/mm^2}} = 3.3495 \times 10^{-3}$$

The elongation of a sample of 76 mm is

$$\Delta l = \varepsilon_y \, l_0 = 3.3495 \times 10^{-3} \times 76 \text{ mm} = 0.2546 \text{ mm}$$

and the maximum length that it can reach without plastic deformation is

$$l = l_0 + \Delta l = 76 + 0.2546 = \mathbf{76.255 \text{ mm}}$$

RESULT & CHECKS

Checks

- **Units.** (N/mm²)·mm² = N for the load; (N/mm²)/(N/mm²) has no units for the strain; strain × mm = mm for the elongation.
- **Order of magnitude.** $\varepsilon_y = 0.335$ %, a few tenths of a percent, the order of magnitude of the elastic strain of a metal.
- **Limit.** If the load were zero, $l = l_0 = 76$ mm. At the yield load, the sample is only 0.25 mm longer, that is, 0.33 % of its length.

Interpretation

Up to 44.85 kN the sample returns to 76 mm when unloaded. Beyond that load part of the elongation is permanent. The brass elongates very little (a quarter of a millimetre) before it yields: the yield strength is a stress limit, but it translates into a small strain because E is large.

Check against the official solution

Item	Official	Computed	Comment
a. σ_y	345 MPa	345 MPa	agrees
b. σ_{max}, F_{max}	345 MPa, 44 850 N	345 MPa, 44\,850 N	agrees
c. l	76.25 mm	76.25 mm	agrees